

PORTRAIT OF PANOPTIC SPIRITUAL MISANTHROPY

2025

I just realized that the three most significant relationships of my life - that comprise 22 years in total - each fit on one side of the Dark Triad (Narcissism, Machiavellianism, Psychopathy). Admittedly, they're not a perfect fit, but they're very close. One was a covert narcissist, so she doesn't present in the typical manner, which in some sense makes her worse. Another was a textbook Machiavellian. And the last had Borderline Personality Disorder with strong psychotic comorbidities that gave rise to a lot of psychopathic behavior. Accommodating for the fact that the sides of the Dark Triad are personality traits rather than formal disorders, I think they've pretty well nailed it.

So, you might think that now that I've experienced the worst that humanity has to offer, perhaps someone great would finally come along. But no, it seems that the well has simply run dry and there aren't any viable candidates remaining, from which only one conclusion⁵⁰ can be drawn.

⁵⁰ That conclusion is actually rather complex, but I omitted it because this self-absorbed bitch-fest is just a flimsy lead-in to the actual subject.

OPTIMISM

I know what you're going to say, *"That's a defeatist perspective"* and *"You have to adopt an abundance mindset."* While we're all guilty of succumbing to its charm every now and then, the practice of optimistic thinking is predicated on several delusions about reality. So, let's just dispel those real quick:

1. The world is not a meritocracy.
2. Karma does not exist.
3. Fairness and equality are nonsense words that have no real meaning.
4. Some people's lives are objectively better/easier/more enjoyable than others.
5. Many people are faced with more adversity than they can handle.
6. If someone is suffering, that doesn't imply that they did something to cause it.
7. The physical world exists primarily as a place of suffering.⁵¹

HELL

This is Hell. Accept it. Enjoy your stay... or don't. No one really cares.

"But my life is going pretty good. This doesn't feel like Hell to me!"

Just wait...

You see, the classical problem of Hell in the sense of it being a literal lake of fire is that while it would be terribly painful at first, considering that the condemned cannot die and must just sit there and burn for eternity, they would eventually acclimate to the flames and begin to function normally, eventually not even seeing the flames at all!

⁵¹ If this statement bothers you, take it up with Buddha.

They would just go about their routines of eating, sleeping, making things, etc. They would join up with other denizens of Hell to bully the fat kid. I mean, it is Hell, after all, right? Then the fat kids would band together. Then they faction off in different ways, each claiming a region of the pit for their respective clans. They make weapons and go to war, forever reveling in their lower natures and never even caring to imagine what role love, empathy, or compassion might play in this lake of fire.

Despite all of the horrors they're immersed in, the indomitable spirit still manages to find a way to carve out a little area where the fire isn't quite as intense and manages to convince other spirits to stand guard at the gates to secure their little "slice of Heaven" and say that this is all fine.

The (now-deposed) puppet master orchestrating this torture sees this and laughs. He laughs because he knows that in order to maintain long-term suffering, everything can't be just pain and misery all of the time, or else the prisoners will continually acclimate to their conditions. Eventually, he'll run out of torture methods.

It's actually a vital part of high-quality torture to give your prisoners a taste of the outside. Not too much! Just a small glimpse of freedom, a second-hand taste of divinity passed along on the lips of another, a sideways reflected glance at beauty. This builds hope and aspirations within them. If these good times are allowed to linger a while longer, the prisoner will begin to develop pride and indifference (to the suffering of others), which will eventually give rise to arrogance, self-righteousness, bigotry, and eventually megalomania.

From there, it's a simple matter to remove the comforts that provoked those emotions to cause them to tumble back to the bottom of the pit. If they happened to acquiesce to the sin of self-identification with any

of those ephemeral states of being, then there is little chance that they will survive the fall. In that case, they just respawn and now have to suffer the indignities of childhood all over again!

The timing of a prisoner's downfall is all a matter of how far and how hard the prisoner should be made to fall this time. That decision is predicated entirely on how funny it will be to watch. No consideration is given to whether this specific prisoner deserves this torture or not. Why would that matter? The prisoners can't even remember why they are being tortured in the first place and most don't even recognize that's what this is. Therefore, any notion of the prisoners learning or growing from this experience is impossible, hence why they are all sentenced for eternity!

But what about those people alluded to in #4 who have objectively better lives?

They don't really exist. They are automatons or NPCs, if you prefer, who are just going about their lives on autopilot without any concept of what they're doing. For an easy example, consider the wealthy elite. They can't be real people because real people wouldn't behave in the way that they do. A real person would divest themselves of all of that wealth and create systems and infrastructure aimed at reducing the suffering of others. While, on occasion, a real person happens to fall into money and does exactly this, such cases are the penultimate examples of "the exception that proves the rule".

The overwhelming majority of wealthy people behave demonically because they are demons. Their purpose is to contribute to the prisoners' suffering by exacerbating emotions like greed, jealousy, envy, and entitlement. Or, for other prisoners, they evoke the self-inflicted tortures of despair, worthlessness, imposter syndrome, and all other

emotions related to the completely fictitious⁵² notion of self-worth.

Then, through the torture methods of complacency, avarice, and pride, the prisoners can be set against one another, acting as each other's torturer! Once this starts to happen, Hell begins to operate autonomously without even requiring direct intervention from demons to ensure the misery of the inhabitants as they ensure it for themselves by even going so far as to enshrine their own lower nature into the laws they use to govern themselves. This gives rise to perfectly horrible institutions such as slavery, libertarianism, and capitalism.

As this demonic perpetual motion, self-torturing machine carries on, people become anesthetized to the suffering of others. This manifests in a variety of ways including horribly toxic concepts asserting that people deserve the suffering that they endure. In truth, this sentiment is a calloused excuse to turn a blind eye to the suffering of others because one fears that if they didn't, they might be instantly overcome by the magnitude of the suffering around them. Not to mention, the effort required to render aid would quickly surpass their capacity and thus pull them down into the same sort of predicament. But, of course, this too is diseased thinking since one is already in the other person's exact predicament.

REFLECTION

I am well aware that you hate this essay. But I would ask you to first recognize how much of that discomfort you're feeling is truly a response to the legitimacy of what I've said and how much is a product of your desire for this image to not be true. Need I remind you that reality doesn't care about what you *want* to be true.

⁵² Clarification: It's fictitious in the sense that everyone has intrinsic value. But since that value cannot be lost, the concept of self-worth is akin to the concept of the value of water.

You cannot disprove the essential premise of this essay. While it's likewise impossible to categorically prove, the preponderance of evidence points to this being the most logical conclusion.

That being said, some clarification is in order. While the essential premise is sound - aside from the obvious use of anthropomorphization - there are a few specific details included in this essay that were drawn from popular culture and are not necessarily supported by a preponderance of evidence. These are included to provoke the reader to question their validity. For example, the assertion that we are all sentenced for eternity and its implication that there is no escape. That is categorically false. But it's included because billions of people believe damnation to be eternal. Therefore, if there is to be an inquiry into solutions, such ideas must be overcome and doing so must be one aspect of any solution.

The real crux of the issue is the persistent belief that suffering people must have done something to deserve their plight (#6). Not only is that a complete absurd statement when subjected to any level of rational scrutiny, but that mentality is the very essence of evil and the heart of the machine that keeps this torture gallery operating.

While the picture of existence that has been described seems hopeless, is it really? Which specific assertions might not be iron-clad truth and how might we exploit any weaknesses that reveals?

If the puppet master was deposed the moment we became our own torturers, does that not also offer an opportunity to change the conditions of our existence? If so, how might we go about that?

Can it really be that all it takes is for one prisoner to notice the flames and write about it to change the destiny of humanity or are we too

invested in our own misery to accept the possibility?

...and am I not right now contradicting what I said at the beginning about optimistic thinking? Actually, I'm not because what I called *optimistic thinking* was actually nothing more than *entitlement*.